Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 7 6 4 2 ♥ K J 9 8 5 ♦ K Q 7 4 ♣ —	
♠ 10 9 8 ♥ 7 2 ♦ 3 2 ♣ K Q J 10 5 4		♠ 5 3 ♥ 6 ♦ 10 9 6 5 ♣ A 9 8 6 3 2
	♠ A K Q J ♥ A Q 10 4 3 ♦ A J 8 ♣ 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♣	Pass	7♥
All Pass			

7♥ by North
Lead: ♣A

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, but you also have a void in ♣s. You therefore answer 6♣. Partner goes all the way to 7♥.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K 6 5 2 ♥ A Q 7 4 ♦ K 8 6 ♣ A Q	
♠ Q J 8 ♥ 5 3 2 ♦ A 9 7 ♣ 8 6 5 2	N W E S	♠ 4 3 ♥ 9 8 6 ♦ 5 4 2 ♣ 10 9 7 4 3
	♠ A 10 9 7 ♥ K J 10 ♦ Q J 10 3 ♣ K J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♠
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♠ by South
Lead: ♣5

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 15-17 points and 4 ♠s. You have 18 points and 4 ♠s. You plan to bid the slam, but first you check Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner says 5♣.

You are missing 1 Key-Card. Slam has become less certain. You decide to see if partner has the trump Queen so you bid 5♦. Partner bids 5♠. What do you say next?

Partner denies having the ♠Q. Knowing that the best you could hope for would be a finesse to make the slam you give up your quest and pass.

Board 3
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 9 7 ♥ A K 9 6 ♦ A Q 9 7 4 ♣ A 5	
♠ 10 6 2 ♥ Q 2 ♦ 10 5 3 2 ♣ 7 6 4 3		♠ 8 5 4 ♥ J 4 3 ♦ J 8 6 ♣ 10 9 8 2
	♠ A K Q J 3 ♥ 10 8 7 5 ♦ K ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♦
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠4

Your 2♥ bid is a Reverse, showing 17+ points.

There has been no agreement on trumps, so you assume that South has implicitly agreed to ♥s. So you respond 5♣, showing 4 Key-Cards, three Aces and the ♥K. Partner next bids 5♦.

5♦ is the Queen Ask. Partner obviously is thinking about a Grand Slam and wants to know whether you hold the trump Queen (♥Q). Since you do not have the card you return to the agreed trump suit at the lowest level - which is 5♥. Partner now bids 6♥.

Board 4
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 6 3
♥ A K 9 8 6 5
♦ K
♣ A 3 2

♠ 10 9 8 4
♥ 10 4 2
♦ 2
♣ J 10 9 7 5

♠ Q J 5 2
♥ 7
♦ 9 6 4 3
♣ Q 8 6 4

♠ K 7
♥ Q J 3
♦ A Q J 10 8 7 5
♣ K

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5NT[3]
Pass	6♦	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards
3. asks for kings

7NT by South
Lead: ♣J

The bidding has been as shown. Yes, you could have jump-shifted on your first bid.

Slam in ♥s is almost certain, but you should check for Key-Cards. You bid 4NT and partner says 5♣.

Partner shows 1 or 4 Key-cards. Since he jumped on the second round you figure it must be 4. So you have all the Key-Cards. Time to find out about the other Kings, so you bid 5NT. Partner replies 6♦.

Partner has 1 King, the only one left, the ♦K. You can count about 17 high-card tricks available so you bid 7NT.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 10 8 6 ♥ K Q J 8 3 ♦ 10 ♣ A K Q 6	
♠ A J 9 5 4 2 ♥ 5 2 ♦ 9 8 ♣ 7 5 2		♠ K Q 7 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ A 6 5 3 2 ♣ 9 4
	♠ — ♥ A 10 9 6 ♦ K Q J 7 4 ♣ J 10 8 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠K

Your 3♠ bid is a Splinter, agreeing ♥s as trump, and showing opening hand strength with a singleton or void in ♠s.

You have one Key-Card, the ♥A. You also have a ♠ void, but since bidding 6♠ would take you above the 6♥ level you just respond 6♥. Partner will deduce that your void is in ♠s, particularly because you Splintered in that suit. Partner passes your 6♥ bid.